



In cold regions, protect the crown of the plant with a layer of straw or other insulating material. Plants should be replaced every three years, since clumps become less productive with age.

HARVESTING

Abundant flowerbuds are borne from late spring to early summer, and if the stem is cut back, may fruit again in early fall. Cut the heads from about golf-ball size; they can become unappetizingly woolly if larger than a tennis ball. They should be cut with a slight amount of edible stalk; long stalks tend to be woody.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Globe artichokes are largely problem-free, but blackfly and root aphids may target plants. As blackfly affect stalks, wash off by hand or treat with an appropriate insecticide. Little can be done about root aphids, but water and feed plants to help overcome the effect.



Ladybugs will help control aphids.